would prevail this time, the government daily *Rossiyskaia Gazeta* warned the United States and European Union against attempting "to play by the old rules" and not to forget previous commitments that Strauss-Kahn's successor would be chosen "fairly," not based on the candidate's European citizenship.[53]

The two major candidates were Agustín Carstens, president of Mexico's central bank, frequently referred to in the international press as the best candidate from the developing world, and French Finance Minister Christine Lagarde. Unlike the backroom negotiations that had characterized previous selection processes, both Carstens and Lagarde openly campaigned for the job, with Lagarde rapidly flying off to visit, in succession, Brazil, China, India, and Russia—all of whom refrained from early endorsement of either candidate. In the end, Brazil and Russia publicly supported Lagarde. The government of Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, of the left-leaning Workers' Party, was uncomfortable with Carstens's orthodox financial views, and likely was also influenced by its long-standing rivalry with Mexico as the leading country within Latin America.

In a May 27, 2011, news conference following the G8 summit, then-Russian President Dmitri Medvedev said that non-European countries had the right to nominate candidates "if not for the managing director position, then certainly for the positions of deputy directors," which Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov subsequently called "very logical," noting a "decision in principle" was required to create this "new position."[54] Russia's Finance Minister Aleksei Kudrin said that Lagarde possessed the expertise and qualifications for the post and would show support to the emerging economies, as his deputy and key point man, Sergey Storchak, observed that there were no other candidates of the same "scale, knowledge, and education."[55] Lagarde actively lobbied to secure the BRICs' support for her candidacy. In return for China's support for Lagarde, a European candidate, the IMF created a fourth deputy managing director position, as Medvedev had publicly requested, and filled it with a Chinese economist, Zhu Min.[56]

Moscow's nomination of Marchenko was not the first time that Russia had ventured into the leadership issue. Russia had previously opposed Strauss-Kahn as lacking "the technical qualifications for the job," according to Russia's executive director at the IMF, Aleksei Mozhin. Instead, Moscow had nominated Josef Tosovsky, a former governor of the Czech central bank, former prime minister, and for seven years the chairman of the financial